# David Blakeslee

New York University Abu Dhabi
A5 1141, Saadiyat Island
Abu Dhabi, UAE

Phone: +971 02 628 5365
Mobile: +971 055 601 2320
dsb12@nyu.edu · davidsblakeslee.net

## EMPLOYMENT

| | |
|---|---|
| Associate Professor of Economics, New York University Abu Dhabi | 2021 – present |
| Assistant Professor of Economics, New York University Abu Dhabi | 2013 – 2021 |

## ADMINISTRATIVE ROLES

| | |
|---|---|
| Associate Program Head, Economics, New York University Abu Dhabi | 2026 – present |
| Chair, Economics Junior Faculty Search Committee, New York University Abu Dhabi | 2026 – 27 |

## EDUCATION

| | |
|---|---|
| Ph.D. Economics, Columbia University | 2013 |
| M.Phil. Economics, Columbia University | 2010 |
| M.A. Economics, Columbia University | 2009 |
| M.I.A. International Economics, Columbia University, SIPA | 2007 |
| A.L.B. Economics, Harvard University | 2004 |

## RESEARCH

*Published Papers*

1. "Might India's Use of Groundwater Be Weakly Sustainable?" *Journal of Environmental Economics and Management* (with Mathilde Degois, Ram Fishman, and Esha Zaveri) 2026.
2. "Economic Factors Mediate the Impact of Drought on Farmer Suicides in India," *Global Environmental Change* (with Ram Fishman, Deepak Malghan, and Yoav Rothler) 2024.
3. "Irrigation and the Spatial Pattern of Local Economic Development in India," *Journal of Development Economics* (with Aaditya Dar, Ram Fishman, Samreen Malik, Heitor Pelegrina, and Karan Singh) 2022.
4. "Land Rezoning and Structural Transformation in Rural India: Evidence from the Industrial Areas Program," *World Bank Economic Review* (with Ritam Chaurey, Ram Fishman, and Samreen Malik) 2022.
5. "In the Heat of the Moment: Economic and Non-Economic Drivers of the Weather-Crime Relationship," *Journal of Economic Behavior and Organization* (with Ritam Chaurey, Ram Fishman, Deepak Malghan, and Samreen Malik) 2021.
6. "Way Down in the Hole: Adaptation to Long-Term Water Loss in Rural India," *American Economic Review* (with Ram Fishman and Veena Srinivasan) 2020.
7. "Delivering Education to the Underserved through a Public-Private Partnership in Pakistan," *Review of Economics and Statistics* (with Felipe Barrera, Matthew Hoover, Leigh Linden, Dhushyanth Raju, and Stephen Ryan) 2020.

8. "Politics and Public Goods in Developing Countries: Evidence from the Assassination of Rajiv Gandhi," *Journal of Public Economics* 2018.
9. "Weather Shocks, Agriculture, and Crime: Evidence from India," *Journal of Human Resources* (with Ram Fishman) 2018.

*Working Papers*

1. "Clean Air in the Classroom: Environmental Inputs and Human Capital Formation," Revise and Resubmit, *Journal of Development Economics* (with Nitin Kumar Bharti, Samreen Malik, T. Naeem, and T. Walter) 2025.
2. "Ethno-nationalist Mobilization and the Rise of the BJP," 2019.

*Works in Progress*

1. "Using Scarce Water Efficiently: Can Centralized Irrigation Projects Make a Comeback?" (with Ram Fishman and Dan Oziel)

*Grants*

"Using Scarce Water Efficiently: Can Centralized Irrigation Projects Make a Comeback?" (with Ram Fishman and Dan Oziel)

## REFEREE WORK

American Economic Review; Journal of Political Economy; Quarterly Journal of Economics; Review of Economics and Statistics; Journal of Human Resources; Journal of Development Economics; Journal of Urban Economics; World Development; Journal of Comparative Economics; Economics of Education Review; American Journal of Agricultural Economics; American Economic Journal: Applied Economics; American Economic Journal: Economic Policy; World Bank Economic Review; Weather, Climate, and Society

## TEACHING

*NYU Stern Executive MBA, Abu Dhabi*

| | |
|---|---|
| 2026–27 | Global Economy |

*New York University Abu Dhabi*

| | |
|---|---|
| 2026–27 | Capstone Coordinator, Economics Capstone |
| 2025–26 | Economics Capstone Seminar, Development (thematic seminar, Fall and Spring) |
| 2024–25 | Economics of International Development (Masters Level) |
| 2023–24 | Economics of International Development (Masters Level, January Term); Economics Capstone Seminar, Development (thematic seminar, Fall and Spring) |
| 2022–23 | Economics of International Development (Masters Level); Economics Capstone Seminar, Development (thematic seminar, Fall and Spring) |
| 2021–22 | Development Economics; Economics of International Development (Masters Level) |
| 2020–21 | Development Economics; Intermediate Macroeconomics; Economics of International Development (Masters Level) |
| 2019–20 | Development Economics; Public Economics |
| 2018–19 | Development Economics; Directed Study |
| 2017–18 | Development Economics; Statistics for the Social Sciences |

| | |
|---|---|
| 2016–17 | Intermediate Macroeconomics; Principles of Macroeconomics; Directed Study |
| 2015–16 | Development Economics; Intermediate Macroeconomics; Statistics for the Social Sciences; Principles of Macroeconomics (Summer) |
| 2014–15 | Intermediate Macroeconomics |
| 2013–14 | Development Economics; Public Economics |